AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112A
Cultures I

Main – All Branches
Midterm Exam

2025-2026/Second Semester
Date: 15 April 2026
2:30 – 4:30

mber of Exam Pages: 3 uding this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 Hours**

TRUCTIONS

is Exam consists of **TWO PARTS**.

rt 1 contains **3 Short Answer Questions**. You must choose **TWO** and fully answer them in **RAGRAPH FORMAT**.

rt 2 contains **2 Essay Questions**. You must choose **ONE** of them and fully answer it in **SAY FORMAT**.

ite the question number next to each answer.

not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What were the basic **requirements** for becoming an **Athenian citizen**, and what were the main **rights**, **privileges**, **obligations**, and **responsibilities** of Athenian citizens?
2. What is the history of the **Colosseum**, who built it, and what events took place there in ancient Rome?
3. What were the **cause**, **main events**, and **consequences** of the **Great Fire of Rome in 64 CE**?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(20 points)

Please choose ONE of the essay prompts below and write a comprehensive response in essay format. Your essay should be around 350 words, covering all relevant aspects of the question and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essay with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. How did strict **gender roles** in Athens shape the lives of men and women, and what do they show about the male-controlled system of Classical Athens?
Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

   a. **Introduction (4 marks)** Explain the clear separation between **male and female roles** in Athens and how it strengthened male control in **public and private life**.
   b. **Body Paragraph 1 – Male Roles and Privileges (4 marks)** Describe the roles of Athenian men in politics, law, the military, and trade, and explain how these roles shaped their identity and citizenship.
   c. **Body Paragraph 2 – Female Roles and Restrictions (4 marks)** Explain how women were limited to childbearing, household management, and weaving, and how their exclusion from public life maintained social order.
   d. **Body Paragraph 3 – Legal and Social Status of Women (4 marks)** Discuss women's dependence on a kyrios (male guardian), their lack of political rights, and their confinement to the Oikos (household), and explain how this enforced female subordination.
   e. **Conclusion (4 marks)** Explain how these gender roles were deliberately created to protect patriarchy and restrict citizenship to men.

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5. What does **Nero's Domus Aurea (Golden House)** tell us about his personal power and divine ambitions, and why did it anger the public and get rejected by later emperors?

Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

a. **Introduction (4 marks)** Introduce the Domus Aurea (Golden House) and briefly explain how its size, luxury, and artistic innovation showed Nero's idea of imperial power and divine status.

b. **Body Paragraph 1 – Features of the Domus Aurea (4 marks)** Describe the key features of the Domus Aurea (Golden House) — including its use of gold, rotating ceilings, and artistic innovation — and explain what these reveal about Nero's personal power and divine ambitions.

c. **Body Paragraph 2 – Public Reaction and Resentment (4 marks)** Explain why the public saw the Domus Aurea (Golden House) as wasteful and excessive, and discuss how this anger toward the palace helped bring about Nero's political downfall.

d. **Body Paragraph 3 – Later Imperial Rejection (4 marks)** Discuss why later emperors tore down or repurposed parts of the Domus Aurea (Golden House), and explain what this rejection reveals about how they tried to separate themselves from Nero's legacy.

e. **Conclusion (4 marks)** Explain how the Domus Aurea (Golden House) shows that imperial architecture could both display and damage political authority, and what Nero's palace teaches us about the dangers of excess in Roman political culture.

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End of the Exam!

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